

Landlord Compliance Checklist — Tasmania

The obligations every rental provider must meet under the Residential Tenancy Act 1997.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal advice. Confirm current requirements with Consumer, Building and Occupational Services (CBOS) Tasmania before relying on this checklist alone.

Section 1 — Minimum Standards and Safety

- ☐ [] **Comply with minimum standards under Part 3B** of the Residential Tenancy Act 1997.
- ☐ [] **Comply with smoke alarm requirements under Part 3A**, supported by the Residential Tenancy (Smoke Alarms) Regulations 2022.
- ☐ [] **Keep records of compliance** — inspection records, condition reports, and repair logs that would hold up under scrutiny if a dispute reaches the Residential Tenancy Commissioner.

Section 2 — Bonds

- ☐ [] **Understand tenants pay bonds directly into the Rental Deposit Authority (RDA) via MyBond** — you cannot receive or hold bond funds yourself.
- ☐ [] **Respect the 4-week maximum bond**, which cannot be increased during the tenancy.
- ☐ [] **Process bond-related paperwork within 3 working days** as an agent, where applicable.
- ☐ [] **Never claim fair wear and tear against a bond.**
- ☐ [] **Provide reasons and evidence (invoices, receipts) for any proposed bond deductions.**

Section 3 — Ending a Tenancy

- ☐ [] **Understand Tasmania's termination framework sits between full abolition states and retained no-grounds states.** For periodic tenancies, there's no bare "no reason" ground. For fixed-term tenancies, section 42(1)(d) allows a notice tied to the end of the term without needing a substantive reason — similar in effect to Western Australia's approach for fixed-term endings.
- ☐ [] **Document your grounds carefully** for any periodic tenancy termination, since only specific grounds are available.
- ☐ [] **Follow correct notice periods** for the specific termination pathway you're using.

Section 4 — Rent

- ☐ [] **Follow the 60-day notice requirement and 12-month rule** for rent increases.
- ☐ [] **Be aware tenants can seek a re-determination through the Magistrates Court** if they believe an increase is unreasonable.

Section 5 — Pets

- ☐ [] **Understand consent is required by default** — Tasmania doesn't grant tenants an automatic pet-approval right the way some other states now do.
- ☐ [] **Don't apply a blanket "no pets" policy** — this can amount to an unreasonable refusal if genuinely challenged.
- ☐ [] **Know pet-consent disputes go specifically to TASCAT**, since 20 March 2026 — a different pathway to your other tenancy obligations.
- ☐ [] **Remember assistance animals must be permitted regardless of lease terms**, under federal disability discrimination law.

Section 6 — Disputes

- ☐ [] **Understand the general dispute pathway:** Residential Tenancy Commissioner first, then Magistrates Court for unresolved or complex matters (generally above roughly \$5,000).
- ☐ [] **Know most disputes resolve within 6-8 weeks.**
- ☐ [] **Keep thorough records** across all tenancy management activities — rent payments, repair requests and responses, condition reports, and communications.

Quick Reference — TAS Landlord Compliance Calendar

OBLIGATION	DETAIL
Minimum standards	Part 3B, Residential Tenancy Act 1997
Smoke alarms	Part 3A + 2022 Regulations
Maximum bond	4 weeks' rent, tenant-paid via MyBond
Rent increase	60-day notice, 12-month rule
Periodic tenancy termination	Specific grounds required, no bare "no reason"
Fixed-term termination (at expiry)	Available without stated reason (s42(1)(d))
Pet disputes	TASCAT, since 20 March 2026

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